

Focus

Personal workbook for Chris · advanced amateur (hcp 6.3)

Chris

Score on Focus: 8.1/10

Generated September 25, 2026

8.1 / 10 **A STRENGTH**

Turning focus into your edge

At 8.1, focus is already one of your sharpest tools — you commit to a target and see the shot before you pull the trigger. But a 6.3 handicap gets won or lost on the two or three swing holes each round. The gap now isn't building focus; it's aiming it deliberately at the moments that decide your card. That's what this workbook sharpens.

WHAT YOUR SCORE MEANS

A score of 8.1 sits well above what's typical for a mid-single-digit player. Plenty of golfers your standard commit to targets on easy holes but drift into autopilot under pressure. You're already ahead — this is about polish, not repair.

WHAT YOUR HANDICAP MEANS HERE

At 6.3 your misses are small but expensive: a slightly vague target on a tight par 4, a half-committed 6-iron into a tucked pin, a lazy tee-club choice on a dogleg. The fastest win is treating your two toughest holes with the same precise routine you already own on the easy ones.

WHAT IT GAINS YOU

Sharpening this makes committed focus your signature on the holes that make or break the round. That firm target and clear picture on the tight tee shot or long approach is worth a handful of saved strokes each round — the difference between shooting your handicap and shooting under it.

HOW TO USE IT AS A WEAPON

Aim it at the decisive shot. Before your toughest tee shot or the approach to a tucked pin, deliberately slow the routine: name a target the size of a car, see the shape, commit to the club. One clean, fully-committed swing on the swing hole often saves the round.

Leave this untouched and you'll keep leaking the odd loose swing on the exact holes you most wanted to nail — vague commitment on the shots that count, small bogeys that quietly cost you rounds.

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

Treat this like swing work: one rep changes little, weeks of reps build automatism. Pick one or two exercises that speak to you and repeat them over several rounds — the routine wears a groove until it runs without thinking. Don't chase all fifteen. Small, repeated, deliberate.

→ **Grab your phone now and block one 8-minute planning moment this week.**

THE ANGLES AND EXERCISES

These are a menu, not a to-do list. Pick one or two that appeal each week and repeat them — doing everything at once backfires and stalls you. Small steps you actually keep beat a big plan you abandon. Choose what fits your week.

1. Choosing the target area

You already aim, but the finest players shrink the target. 'Left side of the fairway' becomes 'that dark patch by the 150 post'. A smaller target sharpens commitment and quiets doubt. At your level this is the difference between a good drive and one that leaves the ideal angle.

ON THE COURSE · Shrink the target

2 min per hole · first 6 holes, 1 round per week

Why — Naming a target the size of a car turns aiming from a vague wish into a decision — that's where the good swings live.

1. On each tee, pick one small, specific landing spot — a tree, bunker edge, discoloured patch. 2. Say it out loud or in your head: 'that spot'. 3. Set up only once you can see it clearly. 4. Swing. Compare where the ball finished to your named spot.

AT HOME · Map your home course

8 min · 1× per week

Why — Deciding targets on the couch means zero doubt on the tee — the thinking's done before you ever stand over it.

1. Picture the first six holes of your home course. 2. For each, choose the exact landing spot for your tee shot — not 'the fairway', a precise point. 3. Write down why: angle, avoiding a bunker, leaving a full wedge. 4. Replay it once as a clear image.

DRILL · Coin on the range

12 min · 2× per week

Why — Aiming at a coin instead of a green trains your eye to lock on small — and small targets sharpen every swing.

Place a towel or coin at your target distance on the range. Hit 10 balls, each aimed to land on that exact spot. Score yourself: how many landed within a flag's length? Repeat next session and beat it.

Tip — The smaller the target you name, the tighter your dispersion — even a miss stays close.

Tip — If you can't name your target in five words, you're not ready to swing yet.

2. Seeing the ball flight

You likely picture shots already — now make it deliberate. Before every swing, see the shape, height and landing before you move. For a 6.3 this matters most on approaches: seeing a soft fade holding a right pin builds the commitment that produces it. The image programs the swing.

ON THE COURSE · **Movie before the swing**

15 sec per shot · every approach, 1 round per week

Why — One clear mental picture of the flight commits your body to it — skip it and you're just hitting, not playing.

1. Stand behind the ball. 2. Run a two-second 'movie': starting line, shape, apex height, where it lands and rolls. 3. Only when the movie is clear do you step in. 4. If the picture blurs, step back and reset. Swing to match what you saw.

AT HOME · **Rehearse three shapes**

6 min · 2× per week

Why — Building vivid pictures at home makes them appear instantly on the course, when there's no time to construct them.

1. Sit quietly, eyes closed. 2. Picture a stock straight 7-iron: flight, apex, landing, roll. Make it vivid. 3. Now a soft fade holding a right pin. 4. Now a low punch under wind. 5. Replay whichever you'll need in your next round.

DRILL · **Call the flight**

12 min · 2× per week

Why — Announcing the flight before each ball forces you to commit to a picture — vague pictures make vague swings.

On the range, before every ball, say the exact flight aloud: 'low draw, lands short-right, releases'. Hit it. Did it match? Do 15 balls, alternating shapes. Reward yourself only when the flight matches the call.

Tip — See the ball landing, not just launching — the landing spot is the real target.

Tip — A blurry picture means doubt; step back and rebuild it before you commit.

3. Club selection with conviction

Doubt about the club is doubt in the swing. At your level the classic leak is second-guessing between clubs over a long approach, then decelerating. Once you decide, the club is decided. Conviction produces the free swing; hesitation produces the flinch you know all too well.

ON THE COURSE · One club, no return

10 sec per shot · every approach, 1 round per week

Why — Locking the club and never revisiting it is the cheapest way to protect your swing — hesitation is what costs strokes.

1. Read the number, wind and lie. 2. Choose your club and commit — 'this is the shot'. 3. Rule: once it's in your hand, no swapping. 4. If real doubt hits, step off entirely, re-read, re-choose — then no return. Trust it fully.

AT HOME · Yardage decision drill

7 min · 1× per week

Why — Rehearsing quick, firm choices at home builds the decisiveness that stops the between-clubs freeze on the course.

1. Write ten realistic scenarios: '158 to the pin, hurting wind, ball above feet'. 2. For each, decide your club within five seconds and note it. 3. Add a reason. 4. Notice which situations make you waver — those are your on-course doubt triggers.

DRILL · Commit and go

10 min · 2× per week

Why — Practising the full commit-then-swing rhythm grooves conviction so it's automatic when the shot actually matters.

On the range, pick a target and club, commit aloud, and swing within eight seconds — no hovering. Repeat 12 times. The goal isn't the strike; it's decisive commitment before every swing.

Tip — When between clubs, take the longer one and swing smooth — better than a forced hard swing.

Tip — If you're still deciding at address, you've started too early. Step off.

4. Course management at your level

This is where a 6.3 saves the most: playing each hole to your game, not the card's temptation. Firing at a tucked pin over water when the middle is fine, or taking driver on a tight dogleg where 3-wood leaves 130 in play. Smart risk, matched to your ability, is where the polished player pulls away.

ON THE COURSE · Pick your miss

15 sec per shot · every par 4/5, 1 round per week

Why — Choosing where a miss is safe before you swing turns a bogey into a par-save chance — that's real course management.

1. Before each approach, ask: 'Where's the trouble, and where's the safe miss?' 2. Aim to give yourself the easiest up-and-down if you miss. 3. On tucked pins, commit to the fat part of the green. 4. Only fire at the flag when the miss is also fine.

AT HOME · Replan your two hardest

8 min · 1× per week

Why — Rethinking your bogey holes on paper turns repeated mistakes into a clear, calmer plan you can trust.

1. Name the two holes you bogey most. 2. Write your usual play and where it went wrong. 3. Design a smarter strategy — different tee club, aiming point, laying up. 4. Picture playing it the new way to a stress-free par or bogey.

DRILL · Risk-reward scoring

1 min per hole · 1 round per week

Why — Tracking your aggressive versus conservative choices shows you honestly which gambles actually pay for your game.

For one round, mark each approach: A (fired at flag) or C (played safe). Note the result. After the round, tally which choice scored better. Let the numbers guide next round's decisions.

Tip — Bogey is rarely the disaster; double is. Manage to keep double off your card.

Tip — Ask on each tee: what score protects my round here? Play for that.

5. Summoning the feel

The final layer: not just the picture, but the feel of the swing that makes it. A practice swing that actually rehearses the intended shot — the tempo of a soft wedge, the release of a draw. At your level this bridges seeing and doing, so the real swing has already been felt once.

ON THE COURSE · Feel the shot first

10 sec per shot · every approach, 1 round per week

Why — A practice swing that rehearses the real feel means the shot's already lived once — the real one just repeats it.

1. After you see the flight, take one practice swing that feels like that exact shot — the tempo, the length, the release. 2. Not a generic loosener — the feel of this shot. 3. Step in while the feel is fresh. 4. Repeat it for real.

AT HOME · Feel without a club

5 min · 2× per week

Why — Rehearsing tempo and release at home stores the feel, so it's ready to summon instantly on the course.

1. Stand up, no club. 2. Slowly rehearse the feel of a smooth 8-iron — the unhurried tempo, the balanced finish. 3. Now feel a firmer, longer swing. 4. Notice the difference in your hands and rhythm. 5. Store both feelings to recall on the course.

DRILL · Match feel to flight

12 min · 2× per week

Why — Pairing a rehearsed feel with each shot on the range grooves the link so it fires automatically under pressure.

On the range, before each ball: picture the flight, then take one practice swing rehearsing its feel, then hit. 12 balls, varying shots. The rule: the practice swing must match the shot you're about to play.

Tip — Your practice swing is a rehearsal, not a warm-up — make it the shot you want.

Tip — If your practice swing feels nothing like the shot, you haven't decided yet.

INSIGHT

Here's what surprises most single-digit players: the best focus isn't more thinking, it's cleaner thinking, finished earlier. Strong players do all their deciding behind the ball — target, shape, club, feel — so that over the ball there's nothing left to decide, only to execute. The moment you're still choosing at address, you've split your attention. Focus is finished before concentration begins; the flinch under pressure is almost always unfinished focus, not a bad swing.

FROM THE GAME

A mid-single-digit player stands on the 17th, a tight par 4, one over his handicap and hungry for a good round. He grabs driver out of habit, sets up half-thinking about the water left, and blocks it into trees.

Double. The next week, same hole: he stops behind the ball, names 3-wood, pictures the shot landing safe right, feels the swing once. Fairway. Simple par. Nothing changed but finishing his focus before he moved.

OBSERVATION POINT · WATCH SOMEONE ELSE

Watching a playing partner's routine costs you nothing and sharpens your eye for what you'll then spot in yourself.

GOOD FOCUS SHOWS IN

Notice the player who stands still behind the ball, looks at one distant point, chooses a club once and never swaps, and steps in only when settled.

WEAK FOCUS SHOWS IN

Watch for the rushed grab of a club, the vague aim at 'the green', and the last-second change of mind while already standing over the ball.

REFLECTION & AI COACHING

Copy a prompt below into an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude) to think it through further yourself — a sounding board that always has time.

STARTER PROMPT — COPY & PASTE

I'm a 6.3 handicap golfer. My focus is a real strength — I commit to targets and picture shots well on easy holes. But on my two or three toughest holes each round, especially tight tee shots and approaches to tucked pins, I sometimes drift into autopilot and swing half-committed. How can I bring my best focus routine deliberately to the holes that decide my round?

DIG DEEPER — 1

On a tight par 4 with water left, I tend to grab driver on autopilot and think about the trouble. Help me build a step-by-step routine that keeps me committed to a smart target.

DIG DEEPER — 2

I picture shots well but under pressure my practice swing stops matching the shot I want. How can I make my practice swing actually rehearse the intended feel?

YOUR PLAN FOR THE COMING WEEKS

A realistic four-week build, roughly 30–40 minutes a week, picking what fits.

Week 1**SHRINK YOUR TARGET** · ±20 min/week

Use 'Shrink the target' on the first six holes of one round. Add 'Map your home course' once at home.

Week 2**SEE AND FEEL THE SHOT** · ±25 min/week

Add the 'Movie before the swing' on approaches, one round. Do 'Rehearse three shapes' twice at home.

Week 3**COMMIT AND MANAGE** · ±30 min/week

Use 'One club, no return' and 'Pick your miss' on par 4s and 5s, one round. Replan your two hardest holes at home.

Week 4**FULL ROUTINE, SWING HOLES** · ±30 min/week

Combine target, picture, club and feel into one routine — apply it fully on your two toughest holes every round.

ON THE COURSE — BEFORE, DURING, AFTER**BEFORE THE ROUND**

- Name your two swing holes and decide their strategy before teeing off.
- Rehearse one clear practice swing on the range that matches a real shot.
- Pick one small target for your opening tee shot, out loud.

DURING

- Name a car-sized target before every tee shot and approach.
- Run a two-second flight movie behind the ball, then step in.
- Choose your club once — no swapping over the ball.

AFTER THE ROUND

- Note which holes you played fully committed versus autopilot.
- Check: on your two hardest holes, did you finish your focus?
- Mark one shot where a clear target saved you strokes.

→ Next round, name a car-sized target out loud on every tee.

QUESTIONS TO ASK YOURSELF

On which holes did I truly finish my focus before swinging?

When did I second-guess a club, and what did it cost me?

Did my practice swing match the shot I actually wanted?

HOW YOU KNOW IT'S WORKING

- ☐ Named a specific target on all 18 tee shots.
- ☐ Zero club changes made over the ball for a full round.
- ☐ Ran a clear flight movie before every approach one round.
- ☐ Played both swing holes with the full committed routine.

→ Pick one exercise, one round this week — that's all it takes to start.

See it, commit it, swing it.

YOUR MANTRA

YOUR COURSE CUE

Name the target, see the flight, commit, swing.